



Tribhuvan University
Faculty of Humanities and Social Sciences

A
PROJECT PROPOSAL
ON
NEPAL BUS TICKET BOOKING SYSTEM
(Course Code: CAPJ356)



Submitted to Department of Information Technology
Kabhre Multiple Campus

*A Proposal submitted for the partial fulfillment of requirements for the degree of
Bachelor in Computer Application (Sixth Semester)*

Submitted by
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Tribhuvan University
Faculty of Humanities and Social Sciences
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Supervisor's Recommendation

I hereby recommend that this project proposal prepared under my supervision by **Nischal Shrestha** entitled “**NEPAL BUS TICKET BOOKING SYSTEM**” in partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of Bachelor of Computer Application is recommended for the proposal defense.

.....
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Letter of Approval

This project proposal entitled “**NEPAL BUS TICKET BOOKING SYSTEM**” by **Nischal Shrestha** as a partial fulfillment of the requirements for the degree of Bachelor in Computer Application (Sixth Semester) has been examined by us and is accepted.

Panel of Examiners:

Name	Signature	Date
1. HOD [HOD Name]		
2.		
3.		
4.		

Abstract

Long-distance bus ticketing in Nepal still depends largely on physical counters, phone calls, and local agents. This causes problems for passengers, who cannot easily check seat availability or compare fares, and for operators, who manage seat records manually and face double booking and disputes. This project proposes the Nepal Bus Ticket Booking System, a web-based application that lets passengers search for buses by origin, destination, and travel date, choose seats from a visual seat map, and book tickets online. Bus operators can manage routes, buses, schedules, and fares, and administrators can oversee users, bookings, and reports.

The system prevents double booking through a temporary seat-locking mechanism. It uses sorting and searching algorithms to present results by price or departure time, a fare calculation module that supports special pricing rules, and reports on bookings, revenue, and seat occupancy. Online payment is integrated through eSewa, and a booking is confirmed only after the payment is verified. The system will be developed as a responsive web application using Next.js, NestJS, PostgreSQL, and Tailwind CSS.

Keywords: bus ticket booking, seat locking, web application, Nepal, NestJS, PostgreSQL

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CHAPTER 1: INTRODUCTION

1.1 Introduction

Road transport is the main means of long-distance travel in Nepal, and buses connect cities such as Kathmandu, Pokhara, Chitwan, and Birgunj to the rest of the country. Despite this, ticket booking for many bus services still depends on physical counters, phone calls, or local agents. Passengers often have to visit the counter in person to check seat availability, compare prices, or confirm a booking, and operators must manage seat records manually.

The Nepal Bus Ticket Booking System is a web-based application that allows passengers to search for buses, view available seats, and reserve tickets online. Passengers can search by origin, destination, and travel date, select seats from a visual seat map, and receive a booking confirmation. Bus operators can manage their routes, buses, schedules, and fares, while administrators oversee users, bookings, and reports.

The system focuses on solving the problem of double booking through a seat-locking mechanism, which holds a seat temporarily while a passenger completes the booking. It uses sorting and searching algorithms to present results by price or departure time, and a fare calculation module for pricing rules. The system will be developed as a responsive, mobile-friendly web application using Next.js, NestJS, PostgreSQL, and Tailwind CSS. Online payment will be integrated through eSewa.

1.2 Problem Statement

Many long-distance bus services in Nepal still rely on manual ticketing. Passengers must visit counters or contact agents to find out which buses are running, whether seats are available, and what the fare is. Comparing the options of different operators on a route takes time, and a passenger often cannot be sure a seat is confirmed until they reach the counter.

Manual booking also creates problems for operators. Seat records are kept on paper or in separate registers, which makes errors likely. When two agents or counters sell the same seat, double booking occurs and leads to disputes at boarding time. Cancellations, fare changes during festival seasons, and sales reports are hard to track without a central system.

Because of these issues, there is a need for a system that shows live seat availability, prevents the same seat from being booked twice, and gives operators one place to manage routes, schedules, fares, and bookings. This project addresses that need by developing a web-based bus ticket booking system tailored to the Nepali context.

1.3 Objectives

The main objective of this project is to develop a web-based bus ticket booking system that makes seat reservation easier and more reliable for passengers and operators in Nepal.

The specific objectives are:

1. To develop a search module that lets passengers find buses by origin, destination, and travel date, and sort the results by price or departure time.
2. To implement a seat selection and booking module that shows live seat availability and prevents double booking through a temporary seat-locking mechanism.
3. To provide role-based access for passengers, bus operators, and administrators, with secure authentication.
4. To develop a fare calculation module that supports route-based pricing and special pricing rules, such as peak-season fares.
5. To implement a booking and cancellation workflow with online payment through eSewa, confirming a booking only after the payment is verified.
6. To generate reports for operators and administrators, such as total bookings, revenue, and seat occupancy.

1.4 Scope

The scope of this project covers the design and development of a web-based bus ticket booking system for long-distance routes in Nepal. The system is a responsive web application for desktop and mobile browsers and includes the following:

1. Three user roles (passengers, bus operators, and administrators) with registration, login, secure password storage, and role-based access.
2. Management of routes, buses, schedules, and fares by operators and administrators.
3. Searching for buses by origin, destination, and travel date, with results sorted by price or departure time.
4. A visual seat map showing available and booked seats, with temporary seat locking to prevent double booking.
5. Fare calculation with special rules such as peak-season fares, along with booking, cancellation, and booking history with online payment through eSewa.
6. Reports for operators and administrators, such as total bookings, revenue, and seat occupancy.

1.5 Limitations

The system has the following limitations:

1. Payment works only in the eSewa test (sandbox) environment with test accounts, so no real money is processed. Moving to live payments needs a registered merchant account and is left for future work.
2. The system runs on sample data. It is not connected to real bus operators, and the routes and fares are for demonstration only.
3. It does not provide live bus tracking or GPS location.
4. It is a web application only. A native mobile app is not developed.
5. It is not tested for large-scale traffic and is designed for a limited number of users.
6. Notifications such as SMS or email are not included in the current version.

CHAPTER 2: METHODOLOGY

2.1 Requirement Identification

2.1.1 Study of Existing System

Manual system. In the traditional system, a passenger books a long-distance bus ticket by visiting the operator's counter, calling the office, or going through a local agent. The staff check a paper register or a seat chart, tell the passenger which seats are free, take the payment in cash, and write the booking by hand. Each counter or agent keeps its own record, so seat information is not shared in real time. This leads to double booking, long queues, errors in the records, and difficulty in producing sales reports.

Existing online platforms. Several online platforms already offer bus ticket booking in Nepal. BusSewa describes itself as a real-time booking platform that lets passengers search routes, compare fares, choose seats, and receive e-tickets, with payment through wallets, banks, and cards [1]. GoMyGo allows several passengers to be booked in one transaction, sends confirmations by email and SMS, and follows each operator's own cancellation policy [2]. Okay Journey offers an interactive seat map and a choice of bus class [3]. Trip Turbo lets users filter buses by price and departure time, pick window or aisle seats from a seat map, and receive an e-ticket by email and SMS [4].

Comparison. Table 2.1 compares the manual system, the existing online platforms, and the proposed system.

Summary. Existing platforms have solved the main problems of the manual system for the operators they work with. This project does not aim to replace them. Its purpose is to build the core booking logic as a complete system with its own modules: seat locking to prevent double booking, fare rules, sorting and searching of results, role-based management for passengers, operators, and administrators, and reports. The modules are written for this project and not taken from plugins or third-party services, so they can be studied, tested, and extended.

2.1.2 Literature Review

Several studies have looked at online bus ticket reservation, and their basic features are very similar.

Oloyede et al. developed a web-based bus reservation system for a transport service in Nigeria using XHTML, PHP, SQL, Ajax, CSS, and JavaScript [5]. Their system lets users check seat availability, reserve a ticket, and cancel it, and it gives administrators the means to verify users, add vehicles, and generate reports [5]. They report that manual reservation

Table 2.1: Comparison of the manual system, existing platforms, and the proposed system

Feature	Manual system	Existing online platforms	Proposed system
Seat availability	Checked at the counter or by phone	Real-time	Real-time
Seat selection	Done by staff, limited	Interactive seat map	Interactive seat map
Booking record	Paper registers	Stored in a database	Stored in a database
Payment	Cash at the counter	Wallets, banks, cards	eSewa (sandbox test mode)
Notifications	None	Email and SMS	Not included
Operator reports	Hard to prepare	Offered through the platform	Bookings, revenue, occupancy
Scope	Single counter	Commercial, many operators	Academic project, sample data

handled separately at each branch causes delays and risks of duplicate bookings [5]. Their work, however, does not describe how two simultaneous requests for the same seat are handled.

Chavan et al. describe a computerized reservation system to replace manual record keeping, which they say caused errors in data entry and disputes with customers [6]. The system keeps passenger details, seat availability, price per seat, and bill generation, and is built with HTML, PHP, CSS, JavaScript, and MySQL [6]. It is a short study of a basic design and does not cover fare rules or concurrent bookings.

Venkat and Raju present a bus ticketing application built with Django and MySQL [7]. Users search by source, destination, and date, and seat availability is calculated in real time from the booking records [7]. The system also offers fare calculation, booking history, cancellation of future tickets, and an administrative module for routes and bookings [7]. The abstract states that data consistency is maintained for multiple users but does not describe the mechanism used [7].

The seat-conflict problem is treated in more detail in ticketing research for high traffic. Zhang et al. studied a railway ticketing system and note that under heavy load the same ticket can be sold more than once [8]. Their design temporarily locks the seat when an order is created and deducts it only after payment succeeds, and uses an atomic token-deduction step in Redis to prevent overselling [8]. Their system uses microservices and several middleware components, which is far larger than what a single-developer project needs [8].

Summary of the review. The reviewed systems agree on a common core: searching buses, checking seats, booking, cancelling, and administrator management [5, 6, 7]. The simpler systems do not explain how double booking is prevented, while the research on high-traffic ticketing shows that it is the central problem [8]. This project keeps the common core and adds an explicit temporary seat-locking mechanism, role-based management for passengers, operators, and administrators, and fare rules. It also takes a lighter approach than the microservice design in [8], which suits a single-developer project on a single server.

2.1.3 Requirement Analysis

The requirements were identified from the study of the manual system and the existing platforms, and from the objectives of this project. They are divided into functional and non-functional requirements.

Functional requirements

Passenger

1. Register, log in, and log out securely.
2. Search for buses by origin, destination, and travel date, and sort the results by price or departure time.
3. View the seat map of a bus and select one or more available seats.
4. Enter passenger details and pay online through eSewa.
5. View the booking confirmation and the booking history.
6. Cancel a booking according to the cancellation rule set in the system.

Bus operator

1. Log in to a separate operator account.
2. Add and manage buses, including the bus type and seat layout.
3. Add and manage routes, schedules, and fares, including special pricing such as peak-season fares.
4. View the bookings made on their own buses.
5. Cancel a trip when needed.
6. View reports for their own buses, such as bookings, revenue, and seat occupancy.

Administrator

1. Log in to an administrator account.
2. Approve and manage bus operators.

3. Manage user accounts, including blocking an account.
4. View all bookings across the system.
5. View overall reports for all operators.

System

1. Prevent the same seat from being booked by two passengers, holding a selected seat temporarily while the booking is completed.
2. Calculate the fare from the route price and the pricing rules.
3. Confirm a booking only after the payment has been verified with eSewa.
4. Allow each role to access only its own features.

Non-functional requirements

1. *Security*: passwords are stored in hashed form, and only logged-in users can book or manage data.
2. *Data integrity*: a booking, its seats, and its payment status are saved together or not at all.
3. *Usability*: the interface is simple, responsive, and works on mobile and desktop browsers.
4. *Performance*: search results and seat maps load in a reasonable time for the expected number of users.
5. *Maintainability*: the code is organized in separate modules, so features can be changed or extended.
6. *Compatibility*: the system works on current versions of common web browsers.

2.2 Feasibility Study

A feasibility study checks whether the proposed system can be built and used with the available skills, time, and resources. It is considered under three headings.

2.2.1 Technical Feasibility

The system uses open-source technologies that the developer already knows: Next.js and Tailwind CSS for the interface, NestJS for the server, both written in TypeScript, and PostgreSQL for the database. PostgreSQL's transactions and row-level locking support the seat-locking mechanism that prevents double booking. Online payment is integrated through the eSewa ePay sandbox, which provides test accounts and documented request and verification steps. Git and GitHub are used for version control. All of these are well documented and

run on an ordinary computer. The main technical risk is getting the seat locking right when several users request the same seat at once, which will be reduced by using database transactions with row-level locks and by testing the booking flow with simultaneous requests. The project is therefore technically feasible.

2.2.2 Operational Feasibility

The system replaces counter visits and phone calls with web pages that follow a familiar flow: search for a bus, choose a seat, and book. Passengers only need a web browser and an internet connection, and the responsive design lets them use a phone or a computer. Operators and administrators get separate dashboards to manage buses, routes, fares, and bookings, which replaces paper registers. No special training is needed beyond a short introduction to the dashboards. The system runs on sample data, so its use by real operators is not part of this project. The system is operationally feasible.

2.2.3 Economic Feasibility

All the tools used are free, including Node.js, Next.js, NestJS, PostgreSQL, Tailwind CSS, Git, GitHub, and the code editor, so there are no licensing costs. Payment uses the free eSewa sandbox with test accounts, so no payment fees or merchant account are needed during development. The system can be developed and demonstrated on the developer's own computer. The main cost is the developer's time. The expected benefits are less manual work, shorter queues, and fewer record errors for operators, so the system is economically feasible.

2.3 High Level Design of System

2.3.1 Development Methodology

The system is developed using the iterative incremental model of the software development life cycle. Instead of building everything at once, the system is divided into increments. Each increment goes through requirements, design, implementation, and testing, and ends with a working part of the system that is reviewed with the supervisor before the next increment starts. This model suits a single developer with weekly supervisor meetings, because problems in the design are found early, while they are still cheap to fix.

The planned increments are:

1. Authentication and role-based access for passengers, operators, and administrators.
2. Management of buses, routes, schedules, and fares.
3. Bus search and the seat map, with sorting of results.

4. Seat locking and booking, including cancellation.
5. Online payment through eSewa, with payment verification.
6. Special fare rules and reports.

Each increment is tested when it is finished, and a final round of system testing and documentation follows the last increment.

2.3.2 Flow Chart

[To be written]

2.3.3 Working Mechanism of the Proposed System

[To be written]

2.3.4 Description of Algorithms

[To be written]

CHAPTER 3: GANTT CHART

[To be written]

CHAPTER 4: EXPECTED OUTCOME

At the end of the project, the following are expected to be delivered:

1. A working web-based bus ticket booking system with separate access for passengers, bus operators, and administrators, protected by secure login.
2. A search module that finds buses by origin, destination, and travel date, and sorts the results by price or departure time.
3. A seat selection and booking module with a live seat map and a temporary seat-locking mechanism that prevents double booking, tested with simultaneous booking requests.
4. A fare calculation module that supports route-based pricing and special pricing rules, such as peak-season fares.
5. A booking, cancellation, and booking-history workflow with online payment through eSewa, where a booking is confirmed only after the payment is verified.
6. Reports for operators and administrators on bookings, revenue, and seat occupancy.

In addition, the project will deliver complete documentation, including the requirement analysis, design diagrams, and test results, and the source code managed in a Git repository. The system will be a working application, demonstrated with sample data.

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